

Fall 2004, CIS, Temple University

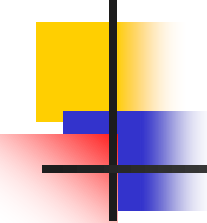
CIS527: Data Warehousing, Filtering, and Mining

Lecture 2

- Data Warehousing and OLAP Technology for Data Mining

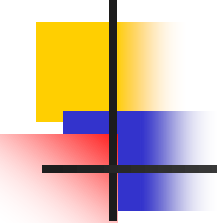
Lecture slides taken/modified from:

- Jiawei Han (http://www-sal.cs.uiuc.edu/~hanj/DM_Book.html)



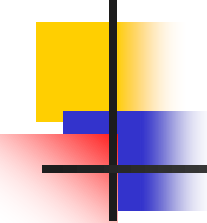
Chapter 2: Data Warehousing and OLAP Technology for Data Mining

- What is a data warehouse?
- A multi-dimensional data model
- Data warehouse architecture
- Data warehouse implementation
- Further development of data cube technology
- From data warehousing to data mining



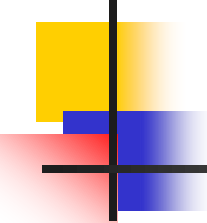
What is Data Warehouse?

- Defined in many different ways, but not rigorously.
 - A decision support database that is maintained **separately** from the organization's operational database
 - Support **information processing** by providing a solid platform of consolidated, historical data for analysis.
- "A data warehouse is a subject-oriented, integrated, time-variant, and nonvolatile collection of data in support of management's decision-making process."—W. H. Inmon
- Data warehousing:
 - The process of constructing and using data warehouses



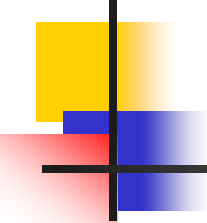
Data Warehouse—Subject-Oriented

- Provide a simple and concise view around particular subject issues by excluding data that are not useful in the decision support process.
- Organized around major subjects, such as customer, product, sales.
- Focusing on the modeling and analysis of data for decision makers, not on daily operations or transaction processing.



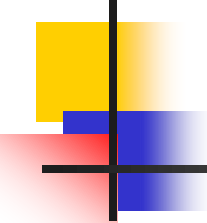
Data Warehouse—Integrated

- Constructed by integrating multiple, heterogeneous data sources
 - relational databases, flat files, on-line transaction records
- Data cleaning and data integration techniques are applied.
 - Ensure consistency in naming conventions, encoding structures, attribute measures, etc. among different data sources
 - E.g., Hotel price: currency, tax, breakfast covered, etc.
 - When data is moved to the warehouse, it is converted.



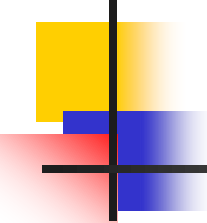
Data Warehouse—Time Variant

- The time horizon for the data warehouse is significantly longer than that of operational systems.
 - Operational database: current value data.
 - Data warehouse data: provide information from a historical perspective (e.g., past 5-10 years)
- Every key structure in the data warehouse
 - Contains an element of time, explicitly or implicitly
 - However, the key of operational data may or may not contain “time element”.



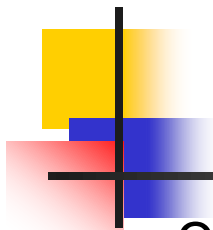
Data Warehouse—Non-Volatile

- A **physically separate store** of data transformed from the operational environment.
- Operational **update of data does not necessarily occur** in the data warehouse environment.
 - Does not require transaction processing, recovery, and concurrency control mechanisms
 - Often requires only two operations in data accessing:
 - *initial loading of data* and *access of data*.



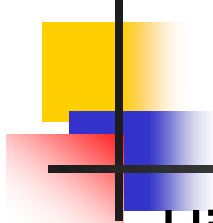
Data Warehouse vs. Heterogeneous DBMS

- Traditional heterogeneous DB integration:
 - Build **wrappers/mediators** on top of heterogeneous databases
 - **Query driven** approach
 - A query posed to a client site is translated into queries appropriate for individual heterogeneous sites; The results are integrated into a global answer set
 - Involving complex information filtering
 - Competition for resources at local sources
- Data warehouse: **update-driven**, high performance
 - Information from heterogeneous sources is integrated in advance and stored in warehouses for direct query and analysis



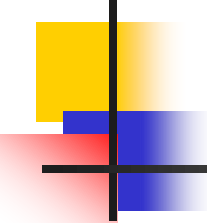
Data Warehouse vs. Operational DBMS

- OLTP (on-line transaction processing)
 - Major task of traditional relational DBMS
 - Day-to-day operations: purchasing, inventory, banking, manufacturing, payroll, registration, accounting, etc.
- OLAP (on-line analytical processing)
 - Major task of data warehouse system
 - Data analysis and decision making
- Distinct features (OLTP vs. OLAP):
 - User and system orientation: customer vs. market
 - Data contents: current, detailed vs. historical, consolidated
 - Database design: ER + application vs. star + subject
 - View: current, local vs. evolutionary, integrated
 - Access patterns: update vs. read-only but complex queries



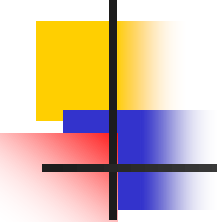
Why Separate Data Warehouse?

- High performance for both systems
 - DBMS—tuned for OLTP: access methods, indexing, concurrency control, recovery
 - Warehouse—tuned for OLAP: complex OLAP queries, multidimensional view, consolidation.
- Different functions and different data:
 - Decision support requires **historical data** which operational DBs do not typically maintain
 - Decision Support requires **consolidation** (aggregation, summarization) of data from heterogeneous sources
 - Different sources typically use **inconsistent data representations**, codes and formats which have to be reconciled



Chapter 2: Data Warehousing and OLAP Technology for Data Mining

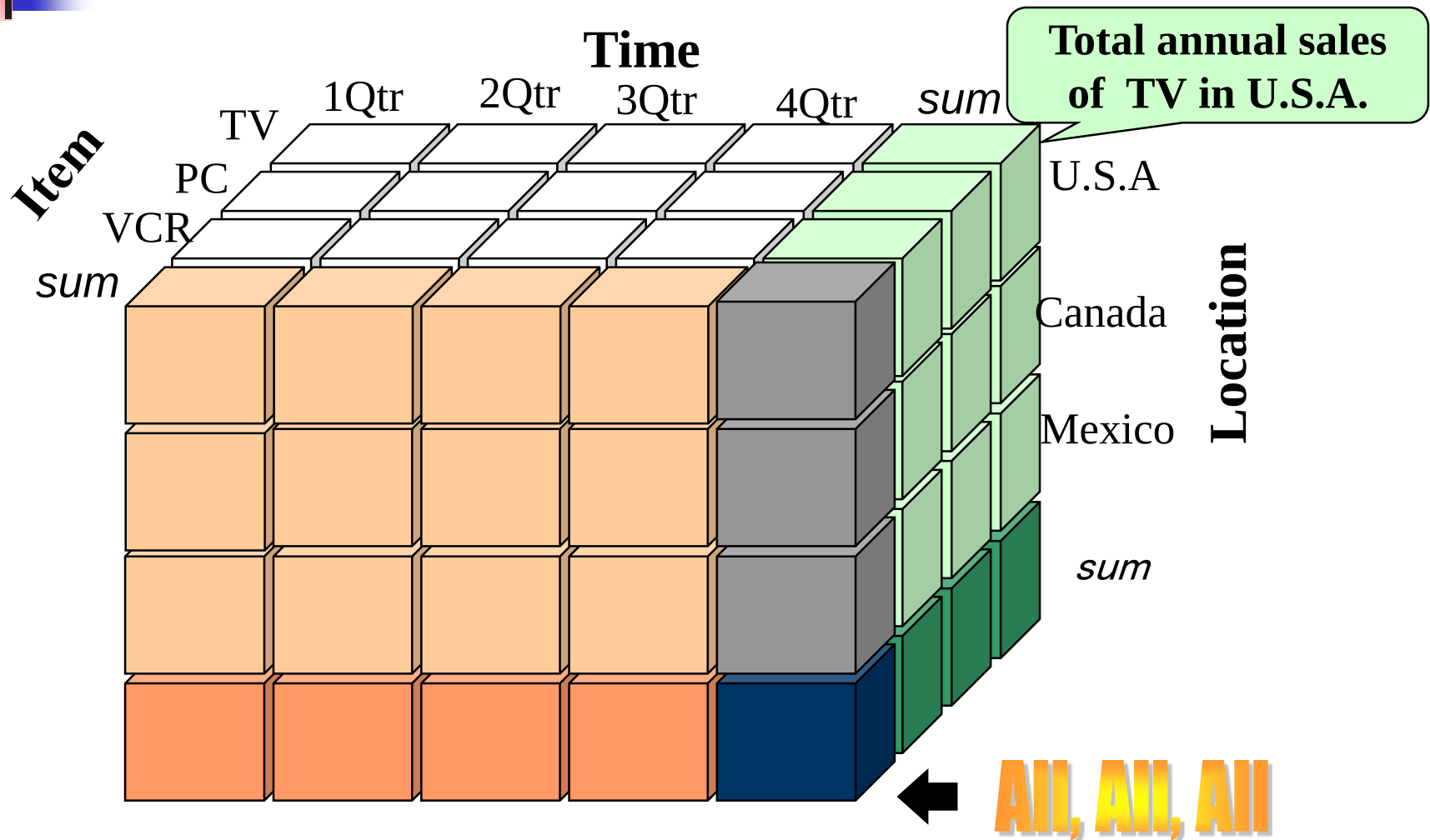
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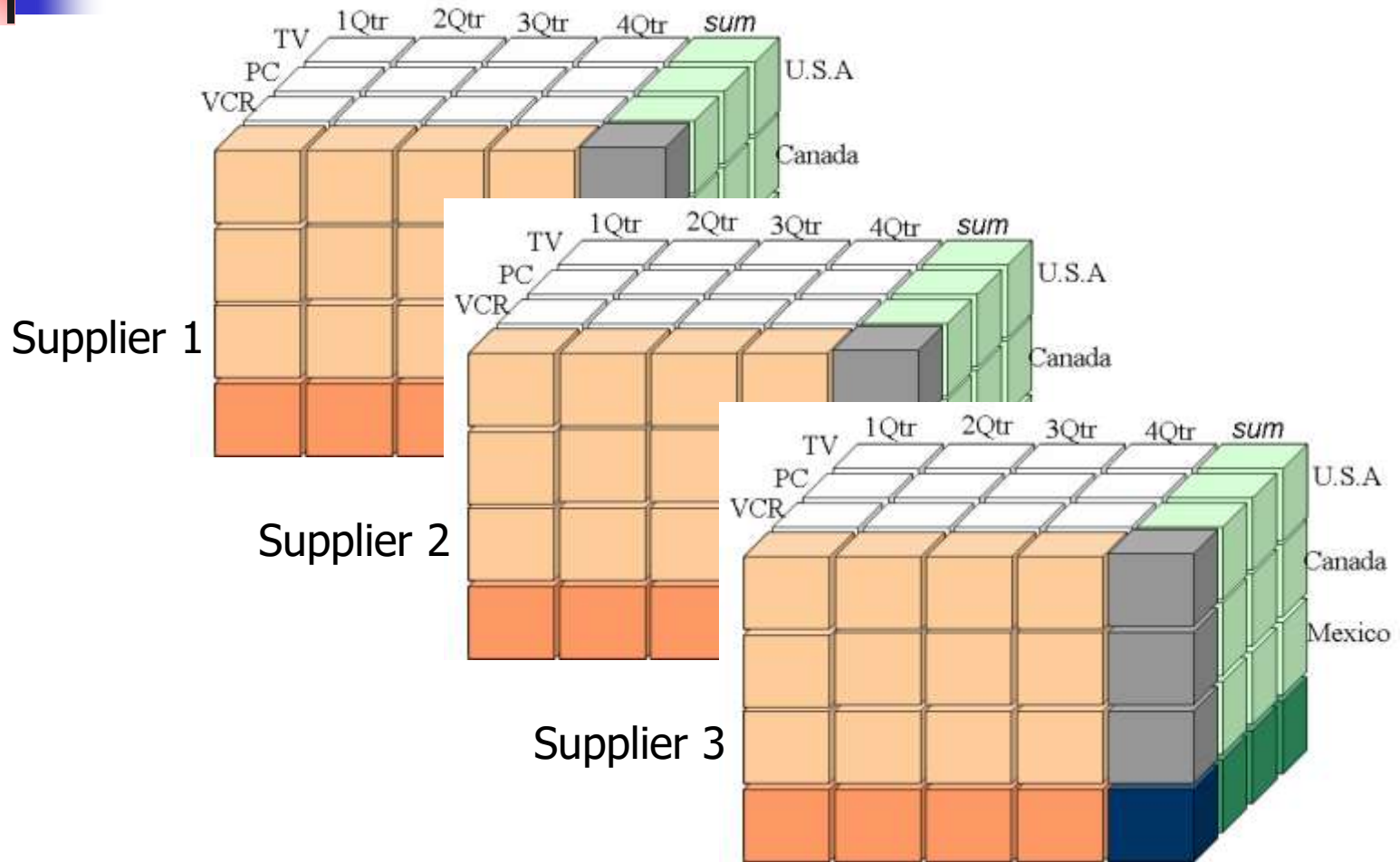
A Multi-Dimensional Data Model

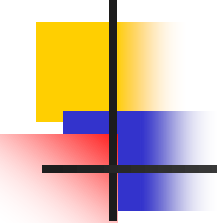
- A data warehouse is based on a **multidimensional data model** which views data in the form of a data cube
- A data cube allows data to be modeled and viewed in multiple dimensions
 - **Dimension tables**, such as **item** (item_name, brand, type), or **time**(day, week, month, quarter, year)
 - **Fact table** contains measures (such as **dollars_sold**) and keys to each of the related dimension tables
- In data warehousing literature, an n-D base cube is called a **base cuboid**. The top most 0-D cuboid, which holds the highest-level of summarization, is called the **apex cuboid**. The lattice of cuboids forms a **data cube**.

A Sample Data Cube

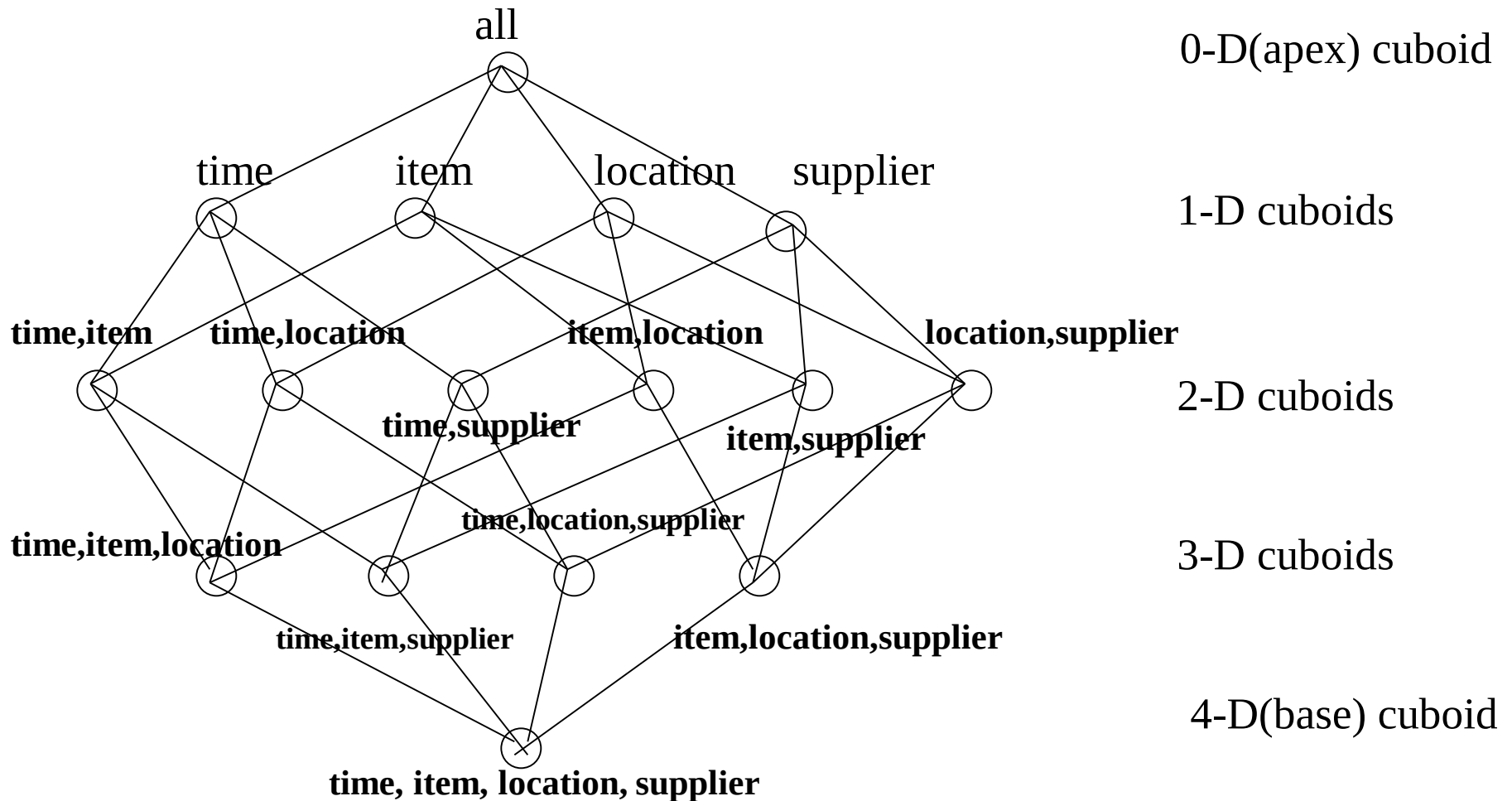


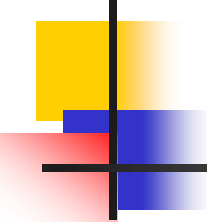
4-D Data Cube





Cube: A Lattice of Cuboids

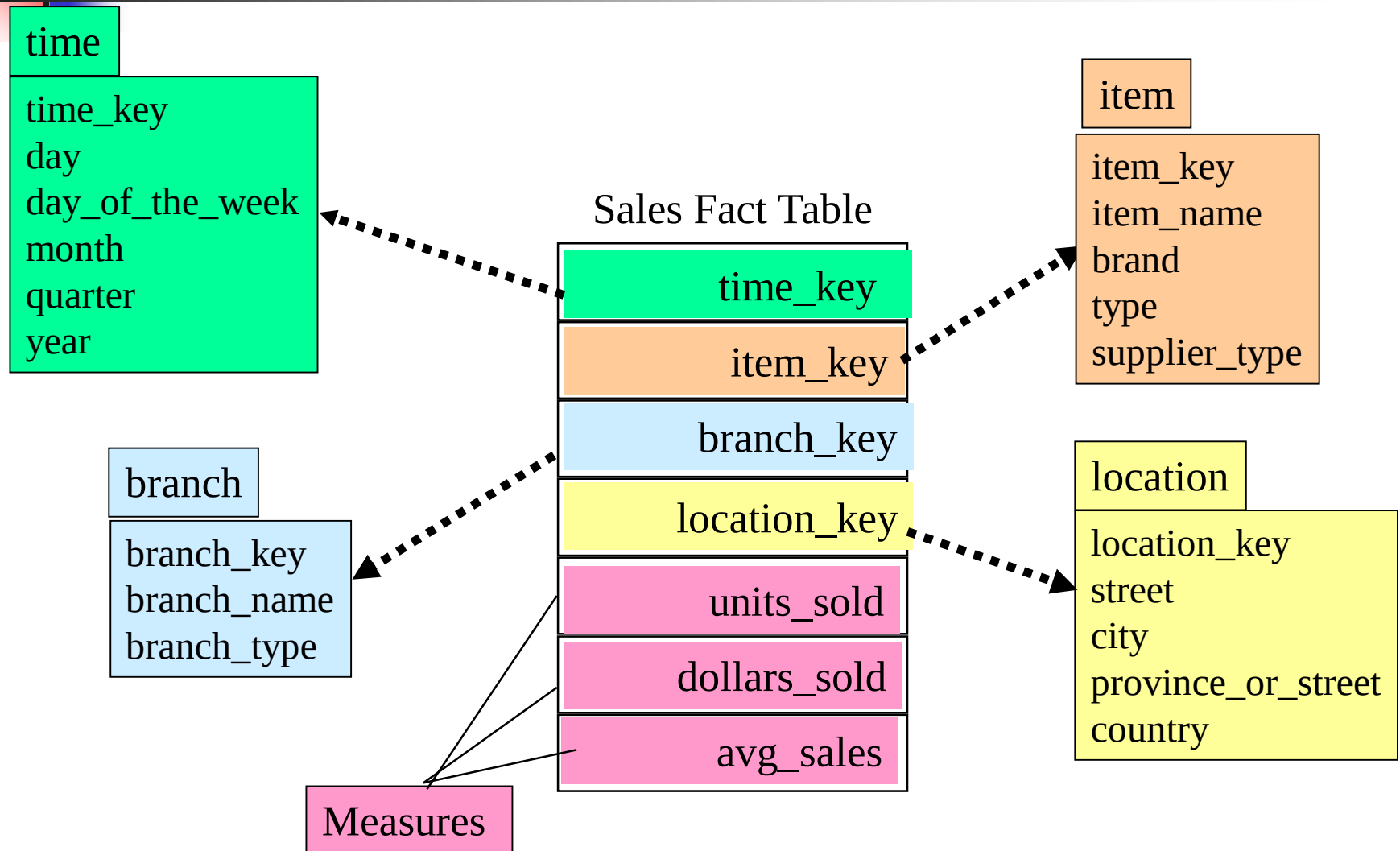




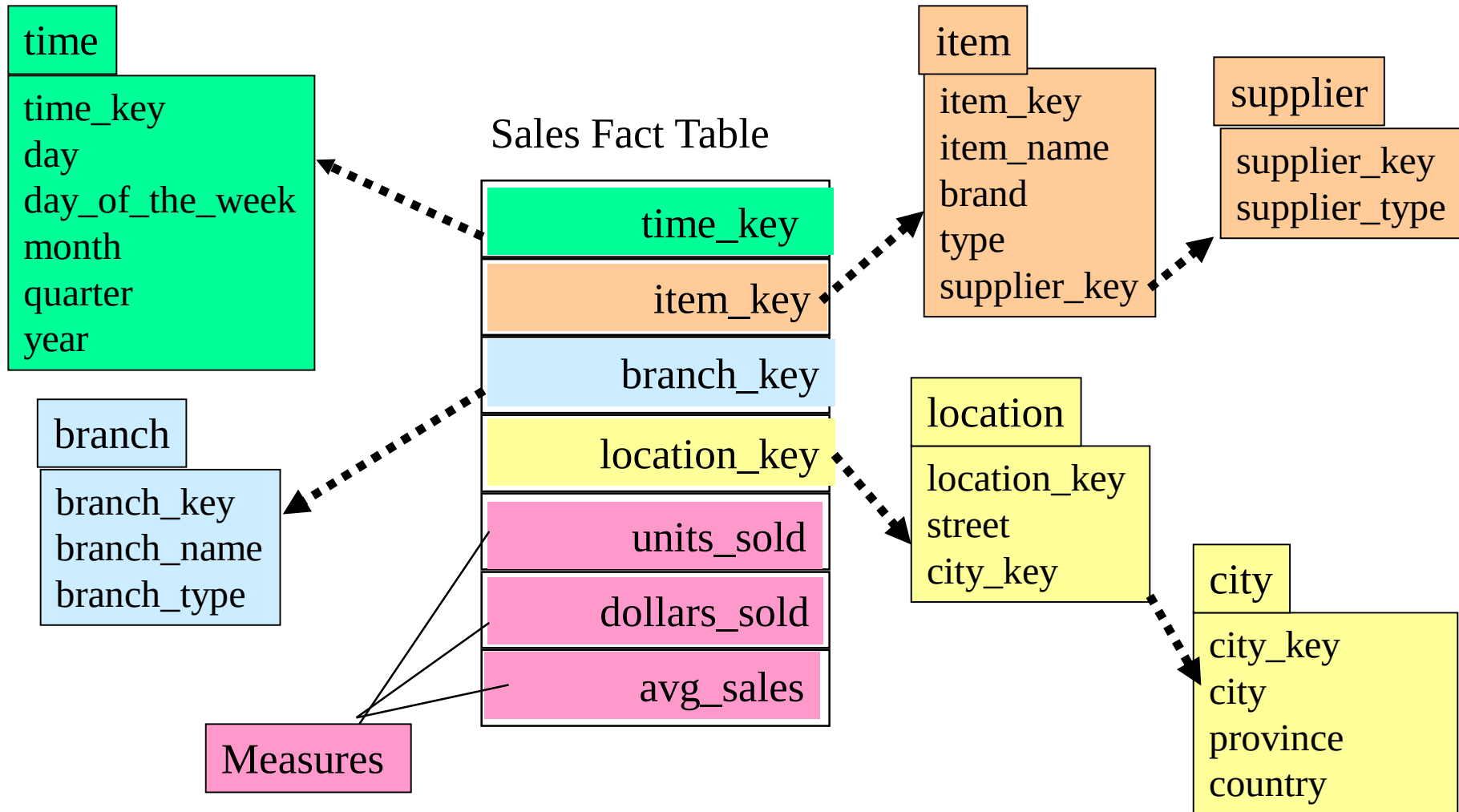
Conceptual Modeling of Data Warehouses

- Modeling data warehouses: dimensions & measures
 - Star schema: A fact table in the middle connected to a set of dimension tables
 - Snowflake schema: A refinement of star schema where some dimensional hierarchy is **normalized** into a set of smaller dimension tables, forming a shape similar to snowflake
 - Fact constellations: Multiple fact tables share dimension tables, viewed as a collection of stars, therefore called **galaxy schema** or fact constellation

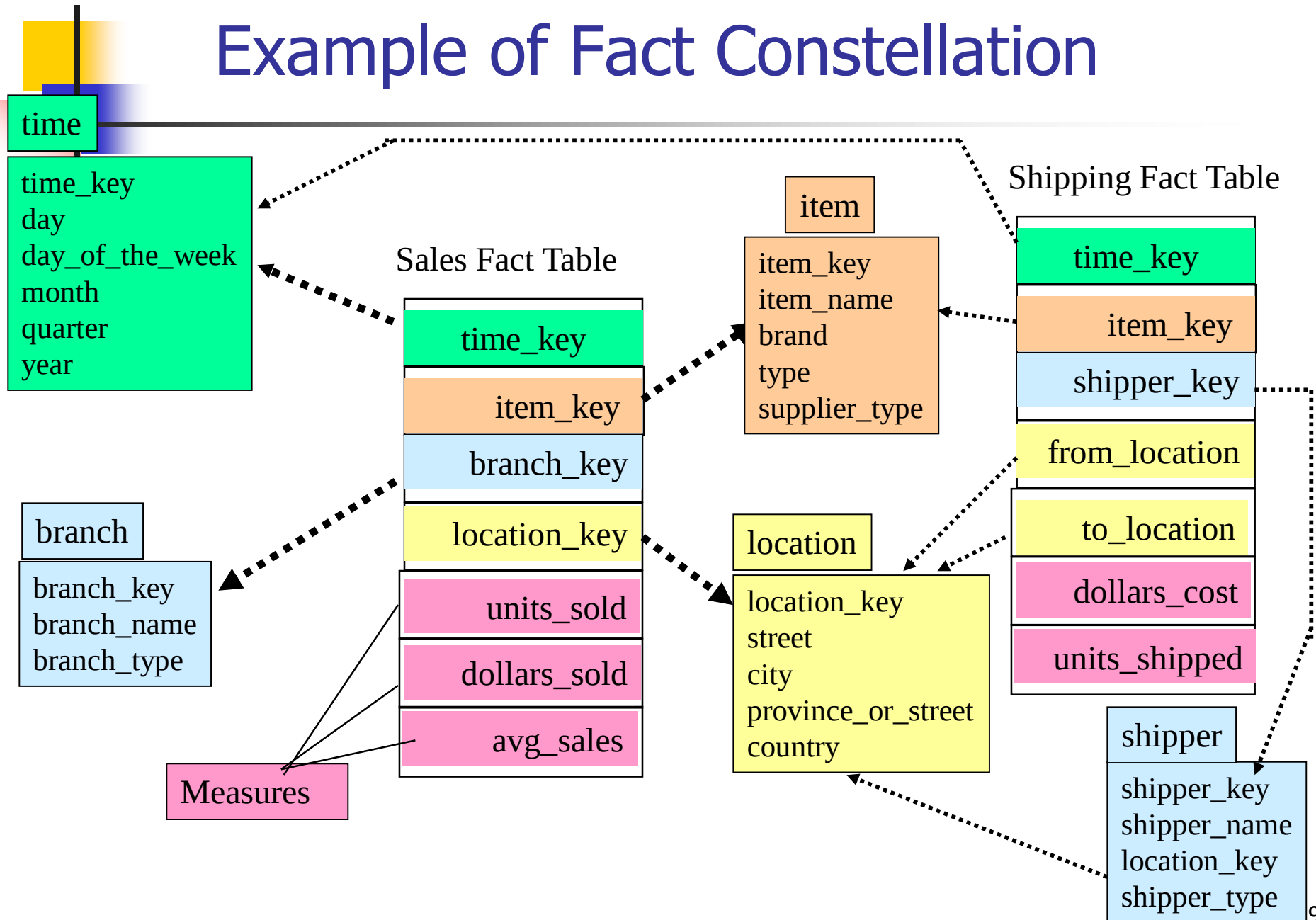
Example of Star Schema

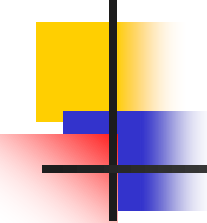


Example of Snowflake Schema



Example of Fact Constellation





A Data Mining Query Language, DMQL: Language Primitives

- Cube Definition (Fact Table)

define cube <cube_name> [<dimension_list>]:
 <measure_list>

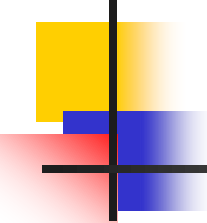
- Dimension Definition (Dimension Table)

define dimension <dimension_name> **as**
 (<attribute_or_subdimension_list>)

- Special Case (Shared Dimension Tables)

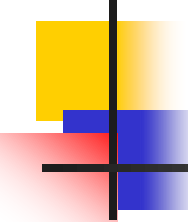
- First time as "cube definition"

- **define dimension** <dimension_name> **as**
 <dimension_name_first_time> **in cube**
 <cube_name_first_time>



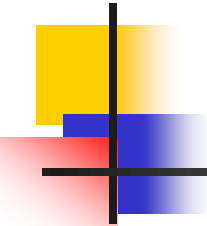
Defining a Star Schema in DMQL

```
define cube sales_star [time, item, branch, location]:  
    dollars_sold = sum(sales_in_dollars), avg_sales =  
        avg(sales_in_dollars), units_sold = count(*)  
define dimension time as (time_key, day, day_of_week,  
    month, quarter, year)  
define dimension item as (item_key, item_name, brand,  
    type, supplier_type)  
define dimension branch as (branch_key, branch_name,  
    branch_type)  
define dimension location as (location_key, street, city,  
    province_or_state, country)
```



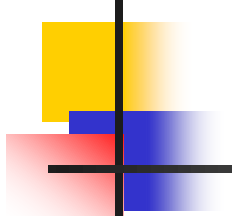
Defining a Snowflake Schema in DMQL

```
define cube sales_snowflake [time, item, branch, location]:  
    dollars_sold = sum(sales_in_dollars), avg_sales =  
        avg(sales_in_dollars), units_sold = count(*)  
  
define dimension time as (time_key, day, day_of_week,  
    month, quarter, year)  
  
define dimension item as (item_key, item_name, brand, type,  
    supplier(supplier_key, supplier_type))  
  
define dimension branch as (branch_key, branch_name,  
    branch_type)  
  
define dimension location as (location_key, street,  
    city(city_key, province_or_state, country))
```



Defining a Fact Constellation in DMQL

```
define cube sales [time, item, branch, location]:  
    dollars_sold = sum(sales_in_dollars), avg_sales =  
        avg(sales_in_dollars), units_sold = count(*)  
define dimension time as (time_key, day, day_of_week, month, quarter, year)  
define dimension item as (item_key, item_name, brand, type, supplier_type)  
define dimension branch as (branch_key, branch_name, branch_type)  
define dimension location as (location_key, street, city, province_or_state,  
    country)  
define cube shipping [time, item, shipper, from_location, to_location]:  
    dollar_cost = sum(cost_in_dollars), unit_shipped = count(*)  
define dimension time as time in cube sales  
define dimension item as item in cube sales  
define dimension shipper as (shipper_key, shipper_name, location as location  
    in cube sales, shipper_type)  
define dimension from_location as location in cube sales  
define dimension to_location as location in cube sales
```



Measures: Three Categories

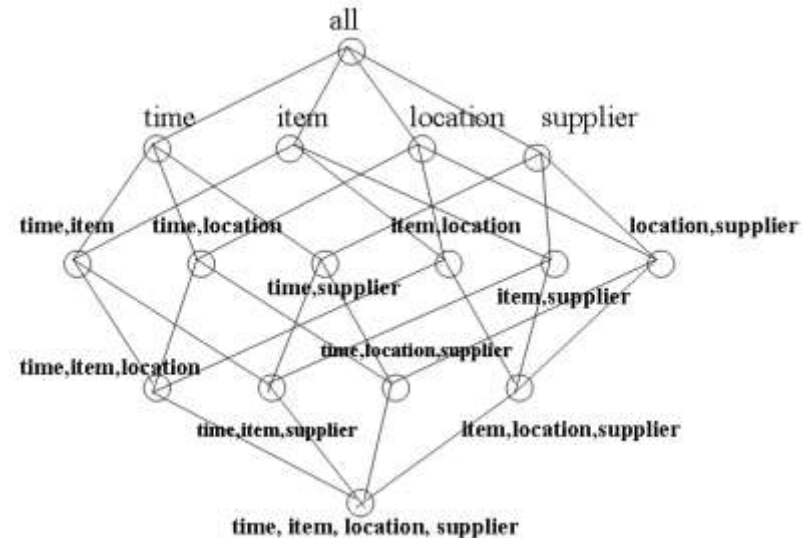
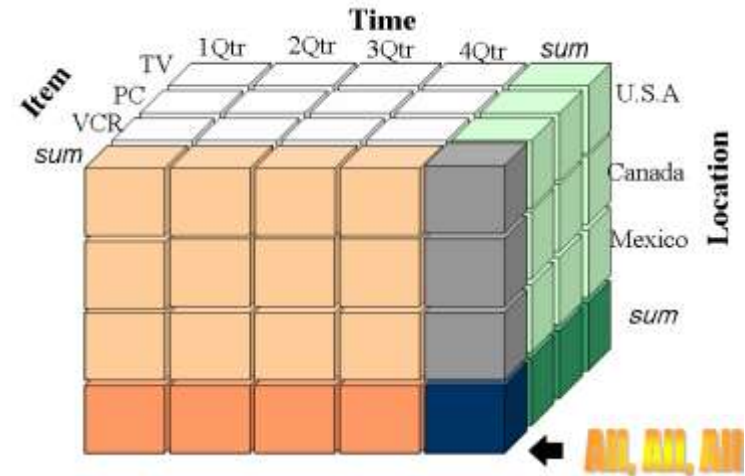
Measure: a function evaluated on aggregated data corresponding to given dimension-value pairs.

Measures can be:

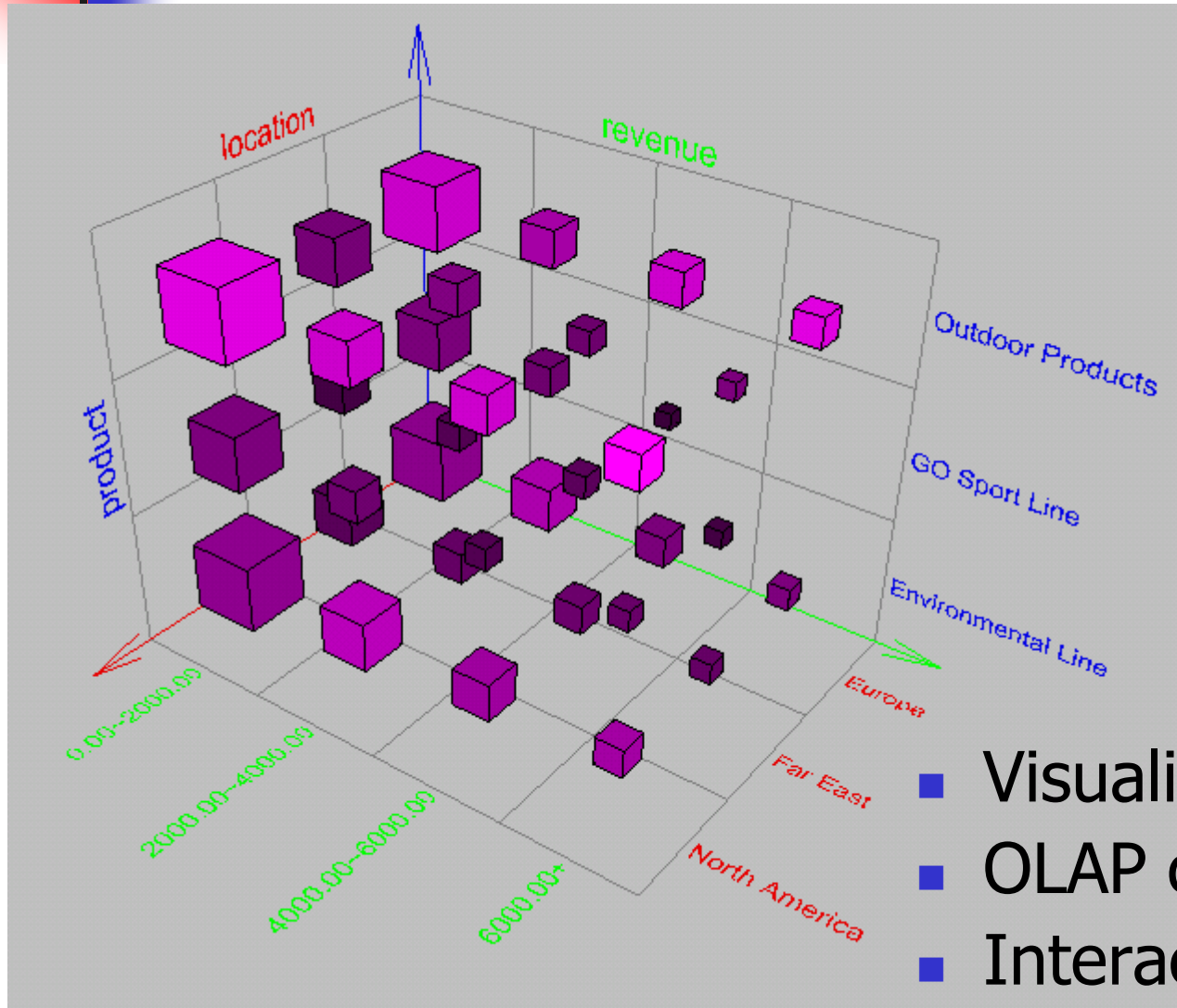
- distributive: if the measure can be calculated in a distributive manner.
 - E.g., `count()`, `sum()`, `min()`, `max()`.
- algebraic: if it can be computed from arguments obtained by applying distributive aggregate functions.
 - E.g., `avg()=sum()/count()`, `min_N()`, `standard_deviation()`.
- holistic: if it is not algebraic.
 - E.g., `median()`, `mode()`, `rank()`.

Measures: Three Categories

- Distributive and algebraic measures are ideal for data cubes.
- Calculated measures at **lower** levels can be used directly at **higher** levels.
- Holistic measures can be difficult to calculate efficiently.
- Holistic measures could often be efficiently **approximated**.



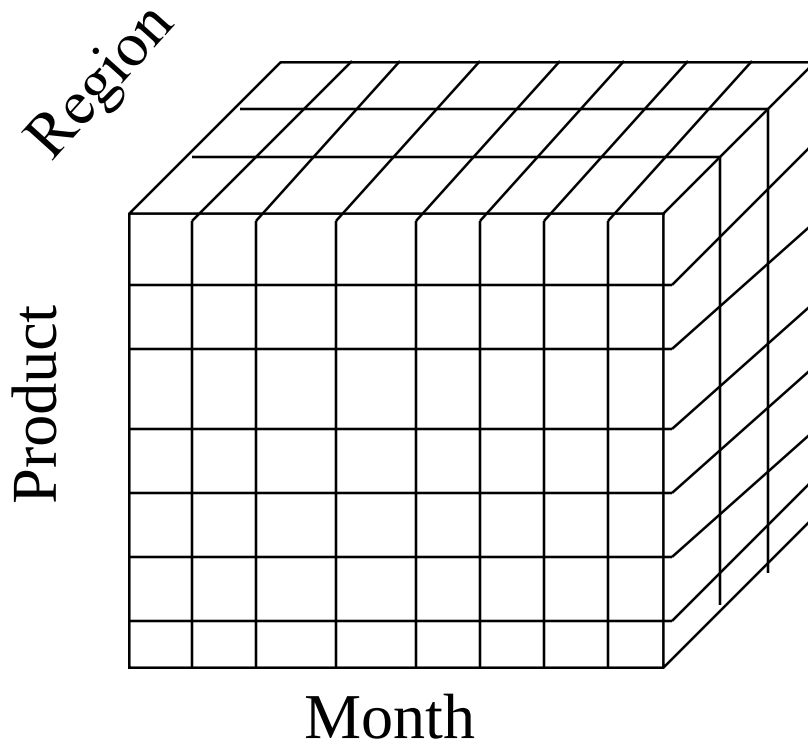
Browsing a Data Cube



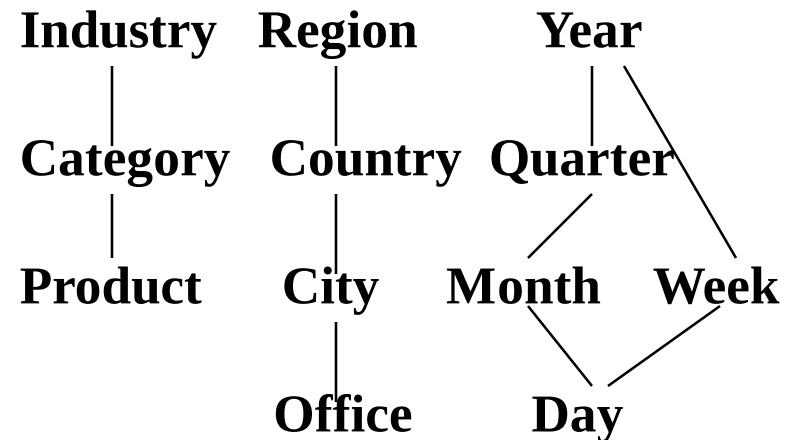
- Visualization
- OLAP capabilities
- Interactive manipulation

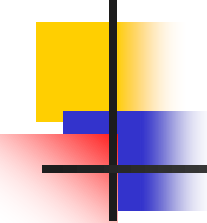
A Concept Hierarchy

- Concept hierarchies allow data to be handled at varying levels of abstraction



Dimensions: Product, Location, Time
Hierarchical summarization paths

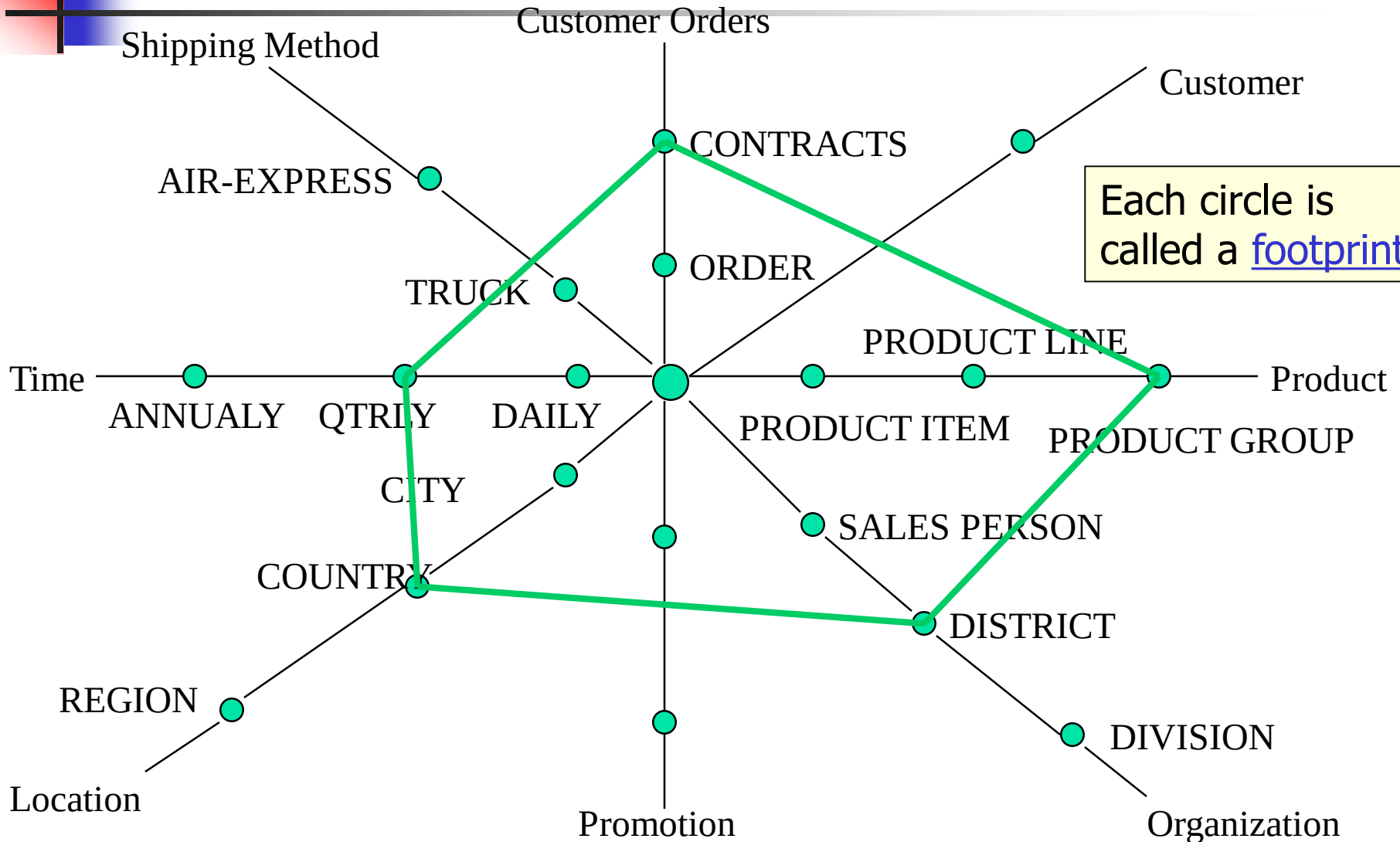


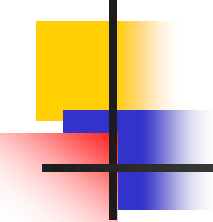


Typical OLAP Operations (Fig 2.10)

- **Roll up (drill-up):** summarize data
 - *by climbing up concept hierarchy or by dimension reduction*
- **Drill down (roll down):** reverse of roll-up
 - *from higher level summary to lower level summary or detailed data, or introducing new dimensions*
- **Slice and dice:**
 - *project and select*
- **Pivot (rotate):**
 - *reorient the cube, visualization, 3D to series of 2D planes.*
- **Other operations**
 - *drill across: involving (across) more than one fact table*
 - *drill through: through the bottom level of the cube to its back-end relational tables (using SQL)*

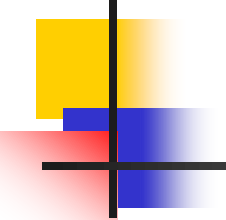
Querying Using a Star-Net Model





Chapter 2: Data Warehousing and OLAP Technology for Data Mining

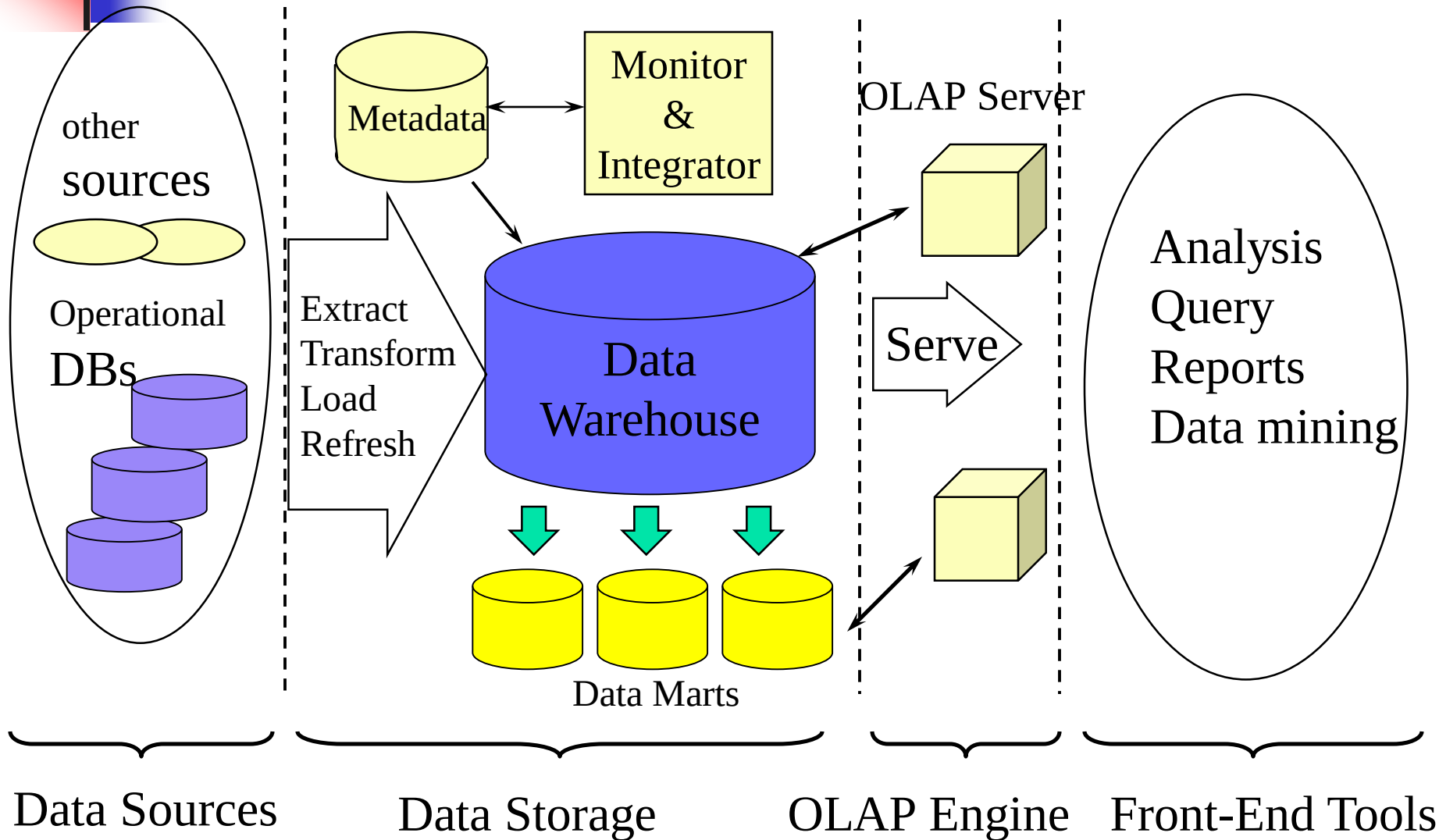
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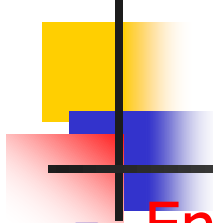


Data Warehouse Design Process

- Top-down, bottom-up approaches or a combination of both
 - Top-down: Starts with overall design and planning (mature)
 - Bottom-up: Starts with experiments and prototypes (rapid)
- From software engineering point of view
 - Waterfall: structured and systematic analysis at each step before proceeding to the next
 - Spiral: rapid generation of increasingly functional systems, quick modifications, timely adaptation of new designs and technologies
- Typical data warehouse design process
 - Choose a **business process** to model, e.g., orders, invoices, etc.
 - Choose the ***grain (atomic level of data)*** of the business process
 - Choose the **dimensions** that will apply to each fact table record
 - Choose the **measure** that will populate each fact table record

Multi-Tiered Architecture





Three Data Warehouse Models

- Enterprise warehouse

- collects all of the information about subjects spanning the entire organization

- Data Mart

- a subset of corporate-wide data that is of value to a specific groups of users. Its scope is confined to specific, selected groups, such as marketing data mart
 - Independent vs. dependent (directly from warehouse) data mart

- Virtual warehouse

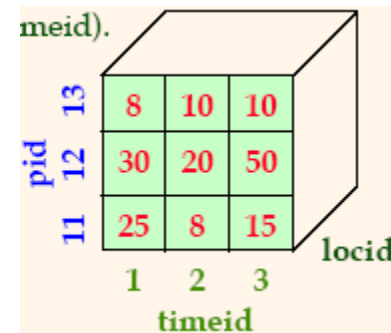
- A set of views over operational databases
- Only some of the possible summary views may be materialized

OLAP Server Architectures

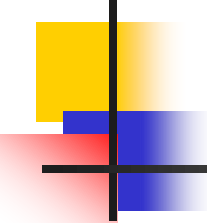
- Relational OLAP (ROLAP)
 - Use relational or extended-relational DBMS to store and manage warehouse data
 - Include optimization of DBMS backend and additional tools and services
 - greater scalability
- Multidimensional OLAP (MOLAP)
 - Array-based multidimensional storage engine (sparse matrix techniques)
 - fast indexing to pre-computed summarized data
- Hybrid OLAP (HOLAP)
 - User flexibility (low level: relational, high-level: array)
- **Specialized SQL servers**
 - specialized support for SQL queries over star/snowflake schemas



pid	timeid	locid	sales
11	1	1	25
11	2	1	8
11	3	1	15
12	1	1	30
12	2	1	20
12	3	1	50
13	1	1	8
13	2	1	10
13	3	1	10
11	1	2	35

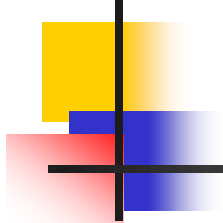


pid	timeid	locid	sales
11	1	1	25
11	2	1	8
11	3	1	15
12	1	1	30
12	2	1	20
12	3	1	50
13	1	1	8
13	2	1	10
13	3	1	10
11	1	2	35



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Efficient Data Cube Computation

- Data cube can be viewed as a lattice of cuboids
 - The bottom-most cuboid is the base cuboid
 - The top-most cuboid (apex) contains only one cell
 - How many cuboids in an n-dimensional cube with L levels?

$$T = \prod_{i=1}^n (L_i + 1)$$

- Materialization of data cube
 - Materialize every (cuboid) (full materialization), none (no materialization), or some (partial materialization)
 - Selection of which cuboids to materialize
 - Based on size, sharing, access frequency, etc.

- Transform it into a SQL-like language (with a new operator **cube by**, introduced by Gray et al.'96)

compute cube sales

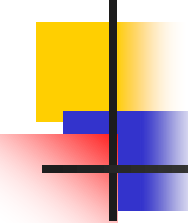
- ```
SELECT item, city, year, SUM (amount)
```

## CUBE BY item, city, year

- $(date, product, customer)$ ,  $(city, item)$   $(city, y$   
 $(date, product), (date, customer), (product, customer),$   
 $(date), (product), (customer)$

## GROUP BY item, year





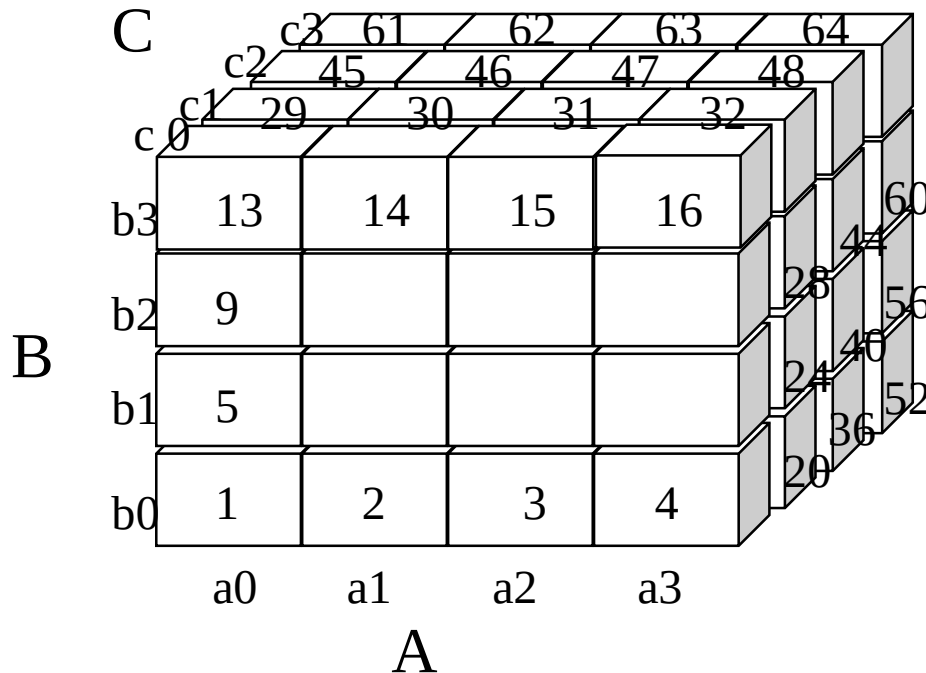
# Cube Computation: ROLAP vs. MOLAP

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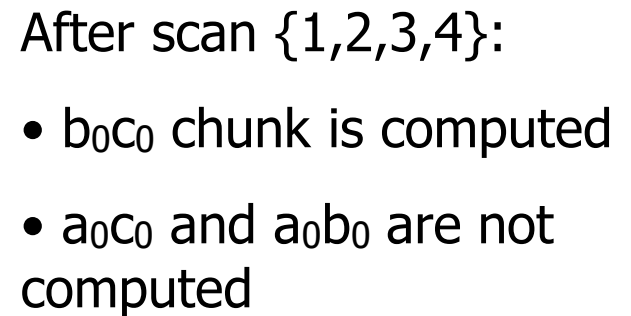
- ROLAP-based cubing algorithms
  - Key-based addressing
  - Sorting, hashing, and grouping operations are applied to the dimension attributes to reorder and cluster related tuples
  - Aggregates may be computed from previously computed aggregates, rather than from the base fact table
- MOLAP-based cubing algorithms
  - Direct array addressing
  - Partition the array into chunks that fit the memory
  - Compute aggregates by visiting cube chunks
  - Possible to exploit ordering of chunks for faster calculation

# Multiway Array Aggregation for MOLAP

- Partition arrays into chunks (a small subcube which fits in memory).
- Compressed sparse array addressing: (chunk\_id, offset)
- Compute aggregates in “multiway” by visiting cube cells in the order which minimizes the # of times to visit each cell, and reduces memory access and storage cost.

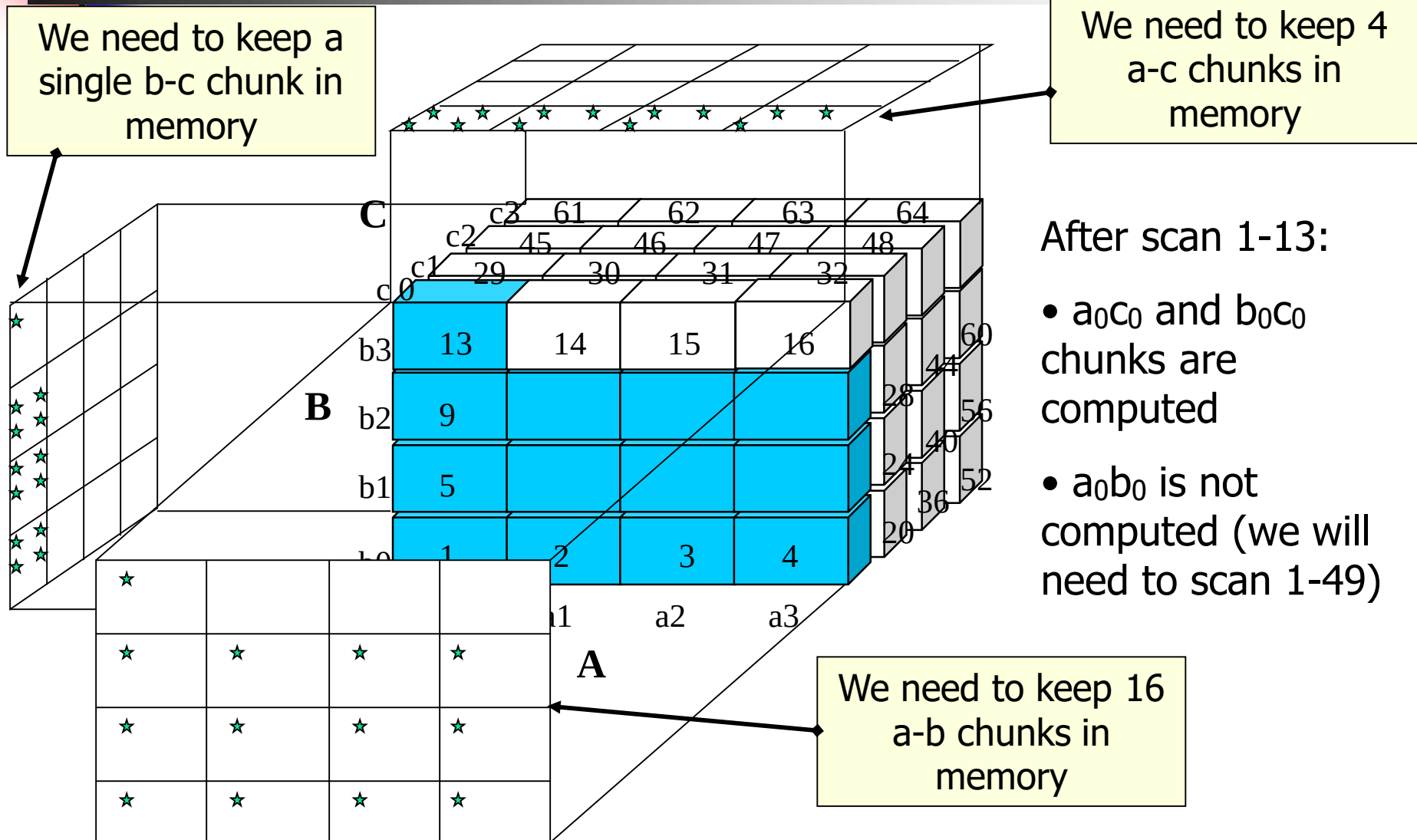


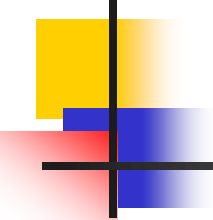
**What is the best traversing order to do multi-way aggregation?**





# Multiway Array Aggregation for MOLAP





# Multiway Array Aggregation for MOLAP

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- Method: the planes should be sorted and computed according to their size in ascending order.
  - The proposed scan is optimal if  $|C| > |B| > |A|$
  - See the details of Example 2.12 (pp. 75-78)
- MOLAP cube computation is faster than ROLAP
- Limitation of MOLAP: computing well only for a small number of dimensions
- If there are a large number of dimensions use the iceberg cube computation: process only “dense” chunks

# Indexing OLAP Data: Bitmap Index

- Suitable for low cardinality domains
- Index on a particular column
- Each value in the column has a bit vector: bit-op is fast
- The length of the bit vector: # of records in the base table
- The  $i$ -th bit is set if the  $i$ -th row of the base table has the value for the indexed column

**Base table**

| Cust | Region  | Type   |
|------|---------|--------|
| C1   | Asia    | Retail |
| C2   | Europe  | Dealer |
| C3   | Asia    | Dealer |
| C4   | America | Retail |
| C5   | Europe  | Dealer |

**Index on Region**

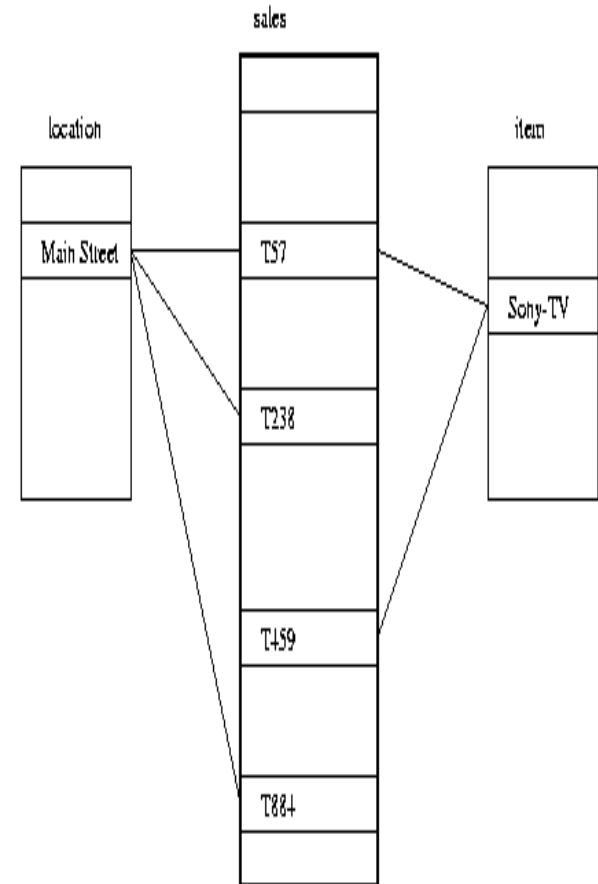
| RecID | Asia | Europe | America |
|-------|------|--------|---------|
| 1     | 1    | 0      | 0       |
| 2     | 0    | 1      | 0       |
| 3     | 1    | 0      | 0       |
| 4     | 0    | 0      | 1       |
| 5     | 0    | 1      | 0       |

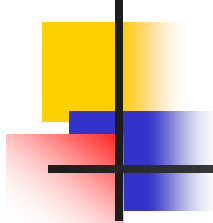
**Index on Type**

| RecID | Retail | Dealer |
|-------|--------|--------|
| 1     | 1      | 0      |
| 2     | 0      | 1      |
| 3     | 0      | 1      |
| 4     | 1      | 0      |
| 5     | 0      | 1      |

# Indexing OLAP Data: Join Indices

- **Join index** materializes relational join and speeds up relational join — a rather costly operation
- In data warehouses, join index relates the values of the dimensions of a star schema to rows in the fact table.
  - E.g. fact table: *Sales* and two dimensions *location* and *item*
    - A join index on *location* is a list of pairs  $\langle \text{loc\_name}, T\_id \rangle$  sorted by location
    - A join index on *location-and-item* is a list of triples  $\langle \text{loc\_name}, \text{item\_name}, T\_id \rangle$  sorted by location and item names
- Search of a join index can still be slow
- **Bitmapped join index** allows speed-up by using bit vectors instead of dimension attribute names

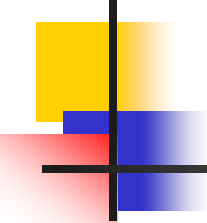




# Online Aggregation

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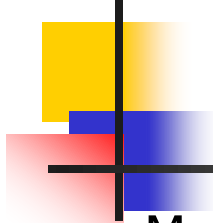
- Consider an aggregate query:  
*"finding the average sales by state"*
- Can we provide the user with some information before the exact average is computed for all states?
  - Solution: show the current "running average" for each state as the computation proceeds.
  - Even better, if we use statistical techniques and sample tuples to aggregate instead of simply scanning the aggregated table, we can provide bounds such as "the average for Wisconsin is  $2000 \pm 102$  with 95% probability."



# Efficient Processing of OLAP Queries

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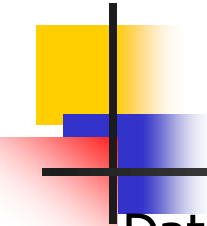
- Determine which operations should be performed on the available cuboids:
  - transform drill, roll, etc. into corresponding SQL and/or OLAP operations, e.g, dice = selection + projection
- Determine to which materialized cuboid(s) the relevant operations should be applied.
- Exploring indexing structures and compressed vs. dense array structures in MOLAP (trade-off between indexing and storage performance)



# Metadata Repository

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- Meta data is the data defining warehouse objects. It has the following kinds
  - Description of the structure of the warehouse
    - schema, view, dimensions, hierarchies, derived data definitions, data mart locations and contents
  - Operational meta-data
    - data lineage (history of migrated data and transformation path), currency of data (active, archived, or purged), monitoring information (warehouse usage statistics, error reports, audit trails)
  - The algorithms used for summarization
  - The mapping from operational environment to the data warehouse
  - Data related to system performance
    - warehouse schema, view and derived data definitions
  - Business data
    - business terms and definitions, ownership of data, charging policies

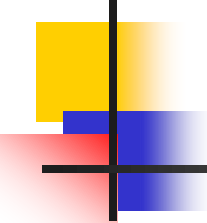


# Data Warehouse Back-End Tools and Utilities

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- Data extraction:
  - get data from multiple, heterogeneous, and external sources
- Data cleaning:
  - detect errors in the data and rectify them when possible
- Data transformation:
  - convert data from legacy or host format to warehouse format
- Load:
  - sort, summarize, consolidate, compute views, check integrity, and build indices and partitions
- Refresh
  - propagate the updates from the data sources to the warehouse

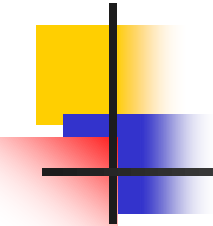




# Chapter 2: Data Warehousing and OLAP Technology for Data Mining

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- What is a data warehouse?
- A multi-dimensional data model
- Data warehouse architecture
- Data warehouse implementation
- Further development of data cube technology
- From data warehousing to data mining



# Discovery-Driven Exploration of Data Cubes

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- Hypothesis-driven: exploration by user, huge search space
- Discovery-driven (Sarawagi et al.'98)
  - pre-compute measures indicating exceptions, guide user in the data analysis, at all levels of aggregation
  - Exception: significantly different from the value anticipated, based on a statistical model
  - Visual cues such as background color are used to reflect the degree of exception of each cell
  - Computation of exception indicator can be overlapped with cube construction

# Examples: Discovery-Driven Data Cubes

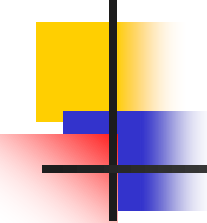
|        |     |
|--------|-----|
| item   | all |
| region | all |

| Sum of sales | month |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
|--------------|-------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
|              | Jan   | Feb | Mar | Apr | May | Jun | Jul | Aug | Sep | Oct | Nov | Dec |
| Total        |       | 1%  | -1% | 0%  | 1%  | 3%  | -1  | -9% | -1% | 2%  | -4% | 3%  |

| Avg sales               | month |     |     |     |     |     |      |      |     |      |      |      |
|-------------------------|-------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|------|-----|------|------|------|
| item                    | Jan   | Feb | Mar | Apr | May | Jun | Jul  | Aug  | Sep | Oct  | Nov  | Dec  |
| Sony b/w printer        |       | 9%  | -8% | 2%  | -5% | 14% | -4%  | 0%   | 41% | -13% | -15% | -11% |
| Sony color printer      |       | 0%  | 0%  | 3%  | 2%  | 4%  | -10% | -13% | 0%  | 4%   | -6%  | 4%   |
| HP b/w printer          |       | -2% | 1%  | 2%  | 3%  | 8%  | 0%   | -12% | -9% | 3%   | -3%  | 6%   |
| HP color printer        |       | 0%  | 0%  | -2% | 1%  | 0%  | -1%  | -7%  | -2% | 1%   | -5%  | 1%   |
| IBM home computer       |       | 1%  | -2% | -1% | -1% | 3%  | 3%   | -10% | 4%  | 1%   | -4%  | -1%  |
| IBM laptop computer     |       | 0%  | 0%  | -1% | 3%  | 4%  | 2%   | -10% | -2% | 0%   | -9%  | 3%   |
| Toshiba home computer   |       | -2% | -5% | 1%  | 1%  | -1% | 1%   | 5%   | -3% | -5%  | -1%  | -1%  |
| Toshiba laptop computer |       | 1%  | 0%  | 3%  | 0%  | -2% | -2%  | -5%  | 3%  | 2%   | -1%  | 0%   |
| Logitech mouse          |       | 3%  | -2% | -1% | 0%  | 4%  | 6%   | -11% | 2%  | 1%   | -4%  | 0%   |
| Ergo-way mouse          |       | 0%  | 0%  | 2%  | 3%  | 1%  | -2%  | -2%  | -5% | 0%   | -5%  | 8%   |

|      |                   |
|------|-------------------|
| item | IBM home computer |
|------|-------------------|

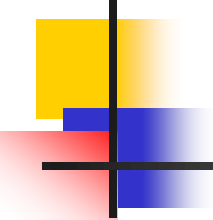
| Avg sales | month |     |     |     |     |     |      |      |      |     |     |     |
|-----------|-------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|------|------|-----|-----|-----|
| region    | Jan   | Feb | Mar | Apr | May | Jun | Jul  | Aug  | Sep  | Oct | Nov | Dec |
| North     |       | -1% | -3% | -1% | 0%  | 3%  | 4%   | -7%  | 1%   | 0%  | -3% | -3% |
| South     |       | -1% | 1%  | -9% | 6%  | -1% | -39% | 9%   | -34% | 4%  | 1%  | 7%  |
| East      |       | -1% | -2% | 2%  | -3% | 1%  | 18%  | -2%  | 11%  | -3% | -2% | -1% |
| West      |       | 4%  | 0%  | -1% | -3% | 5%  | 1%   | -18% | 8%   | 5%  | -8% | 1%  |



# Chapter 2: Data Warehousing and OLAP Technology for Data Mining

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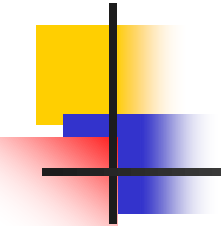
- What is a data warehouse?
- A multi-dimensional data model
- Data warehouse architecture
- Data warehouse implementation
- Further development of data cube technology
- From data warehousing to data mining



# Data Warehouse Usage

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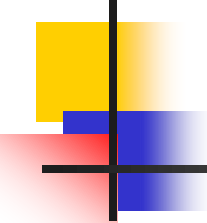
- Three kinds of data warehouse applications
  - **Information processing**
    - supports querying, basic statistical analysis, and reporting using crosstabs, tables, charts and graphs
  - **Analytical processing**
    - multidimensional analysis of data warehouse data
    - supports basic OLAP operations, slice-dice, drilling, pivoting
  - **Data mining**
    - knowledge discovery from hidden patterns
    - supports associations, constructing analytical models, performing classification and prediction, and presenting the mining results using visualization tools.
- Differences among the three tasks



# From On-Line Analytical Processing to On Line Analytical Mining (OLAM)

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- Why online analytical mining?
  - High quality of data in data warehouses
    - DW contains integrated, consistent, cleaned data
  - Available information processing structure surrounding data warehouses
    - ODBC, OLEDB, Web accessing, service facilities, reporting and OLAP tools
  - OLAP-based exploratory data analysis
    - mining with drilling, dicing, pivoting, etc.
  - On-line selection of data mining functions
    - integration and swapping of multiple mining functions, algorithms, and tasks.
- Architecture of OLAM



# Summary

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- **Data warehouse**
  - A subject-oriented, integrated, time-variant, and nonvolatile collection of data in support of management's decision-making process
- A **multi-dimensional model** of a data warehouse
  - Star schema, snowflake schema, fact constellations
  - A data cube consists of dimensions & measures
- **OLAP** operations: drilling, rolling, slicing, dicing and pivoting
- OLAP servers: ROLAP, MOLAP, HOLAP
- Efficient computation of data cubes
  - Partial vs. full vs. no materialization
  - Multiway array aggregation
  - Bitmap index and join index implementations
- Further development of data cube technology
  - Discovery-drive and multi-feature cubes
  - From OLAP to OLAM (on-line analytical mining)